

• HANDS-ON WORKSHOP • 45 MINUTES

Plugins & Skills.

A working tour of the Claude plugin ecosystem
— what each capability is, when to reach for it,
and four hands-on exercises along the way.



Agentic • Automations

SESSION 02 / 2026

4 PARTS
4 HANDS-ON

Skills
Commands
Hooks
Plugins.
Agents
MCP

SIX CAPABILITIES
ONE ROOF

BEGINNER →
INTERMEDIATE

• TODAY'S SESSION

What we'll cover.

01

Foundations

The six capabilities · comparison table · the quick decision rule.

~ 10 MIN

02

Build your own

`plugin-dev` vs `skill-creator`
— when to use which.

~ 8 MIN

03

LegalZoom demo

Run `/review-contract` against a 4-page service agreement.

HANDS-ON · 12 MIN

04

The ecosystem

Business plugins · developer plugins · pick one and try it.

HANDS-ON · 15 MIN

01

• PART ONE

Foundations.

Six capabilities sit under the same roof. Knowing which is which is half the battle.

Six things, one roof.

01

Skills

Reusable instruction packs (`SKILL.md`) that teach Claude a workflow or domain behaviour.

02

Commands

Slash-style runnable prompts. One-click repeatability for common actions.

03

Hooks

Event-driven automation points — guardrails, auto-validation, policy checks in the flow.

04

Plugins

Bundles of skills, commands, hooks and config — portable across projects and teams.

05

Agents

Specialised assistants with scoped instructions and roles — researcher, reviewer, drafter.

06

Connectors / MCP

External data & tool connections — GDrive, Gmail, APIs, enterprise systems via MCP servers.

• THE MATRIX

Same six capabilities — where each one is supported.

CAPABILITY	WHAT IT IS	WHEN TO REACH FOR IT	CLAUDE.AI	CODE / DESKTOP
Skills	Reusable instruction packs (SKILL.md) for a workflow or domain.	Consistent handling of recurring tasks — inbox triage, doc drafting patterns.	LIMITED	FIRST-CLASS
Commands	Slash-style runnable prompts and templates.	One-click repeatability for the same action you do a lot.	PARTIAL	YES
Hooks	Event-driven automation — run logic before / after actions.	Guardrails, auto-validation, or policy checks in flow.	NO DIRECT CONFIG	WHERE SUPPORTED
Plugins	Bundles of skills, tools and config, packaged together.	Portable capabilities across projects and teams.	LIMITED	FULL MODEL
Agents	Specialised assistants with scoped instructions / roles.	Decomposing work by role — researcher, reviewer, drafter.	YES	YES
Connectors / MCP	External data & tool connections via MCP servers / connectors.	Live data, actions, or enterprise system access.	HOSTED	LOCAL + HOSTED

• THE QUICK RULE

Pick by what you need.

- | | | |
|----|--|------------------------------|
| 01 | Need external data or tools | Use connectors / MCP. |
| 02 | Need repeatable workflow behaviour | Use skills. |
| 03 | Need a fast reusable trigger | Use commands. |
| 04 | Need automatic enforcement or QA | Use hooks. |
| 05 | Need packaged distribution | Use plugins. |
| 06 | Need task specialisation or delegation | Use agents. |

• SURFACES

Two places, two postures.

The same words mean different things in different surfaces. Most of this workshop is in Code / Desktop because that's where the full plugin model lives.

CLAUDE.AI

Hosted & managed

Agents and connectors are first-class — the rest is managed for you. You enable a plugin from the directory; you don't author its files.

AGENTS

CONNECTORS

SKILLS (LIMITED)

PLUGINS (LIMITED)

CLAUDE DESKTOP / CODE

Local-first & authorable

You install plugins, author skills, define hooks, run local or hosted MCP servers. Full control of the surface.

SKILLS

COMMANDS

HOOKS

PLUGINS

AGENTS

MCP

02

• PART TWO

Build your own.

Two plugins exist specifically to help you build plugins. They serve different goals — pick the right one.

Two plugins, two scopes.

CLAUDE.COM/PLUGINS/PLUGIN-DEV

plugin-dev

For building **full-scale plugins**. Outputs a folder with `plugin.json`, `SKILL.md` files, scripts, and hooks.

KEY COMMAND `/plugin-dev:create-plugin`

COMPLEXITY

High — manifests, hooks and code.

CLAUDE.COM/PLUGINS/SKILL-CREATOR

skill-creator

For building **specific Skills** — workflows. Output is primarily a high-quality `SKILL.md` file.

KEY COMMAND `/skill-creator` or `/create-skill`

COMPLEXITY

Moderate — focused on prompt engineering.

• SIDE BY SIDE

plugin-dev vs skill-creator at a glance.

FEATURE	PLUGIN-DEV	SKILL-CREATOR
Primary goal	Building full-scale Plugins.	Building specific Skills (workflows).
Output	Folder with <code>plugin.json</code> , <code>SKILL.md</code> , scripts, etc.	Primarily a high-quality <code>SKILL.md</code> file.
Complexity	High — involves manifests, hooks, and code.	Moderate — focused on prompt engineering.
Key command	<code>/plugin-dev:create-plugin</code>	<code>/skill-creator</code> or <code>/create-skill</code>
Testing posture	Focuses on plugin architecture and validation.	Focuses on "evals" — comparing AI performance.

Decide what you'd build.

Think of one repeatable task you do at work — invoice review, weekly status, lead qualification. Decide which builder you'd reach for, and why.

Walk through these prompts

- What's the one task?
- Does it need external data? (then connectors / MCP first)
- Is it a single workflow, or many workflows packaged together?
- Do other teammates need it the same way?

— DECIDE

One workflow, you alone, no external data → **skill-creator.**

Multiple skills + hooks + you want to share it → **plugin-dev.**

THEN

Open Claude Desktop or Code, run the key command, and just start the conversation.

03

• PART THREE

Let's test one.

Install the LegalZoom plugin. Get legal advice on a mock service agreement. See what a real, production plugin feels like.

A plugin that does one thing well.

AI-powered business legal assistance — contract review and attorney consultation.
Three components ship in the bundle.

COMMAND

review-contract

The entrypoint. Hand it a contract; it walks the document and surfaces risks, missing clauses and oddities.

SKILL

attorney-assist

The workflow encoding LegalZoom's review methodology — how to read a contract like an attorney would.

MCP SERVER

legalzoom

Bridge to LegalZoom's services — escalate to a real attorney consultation when the AI hits its limits.

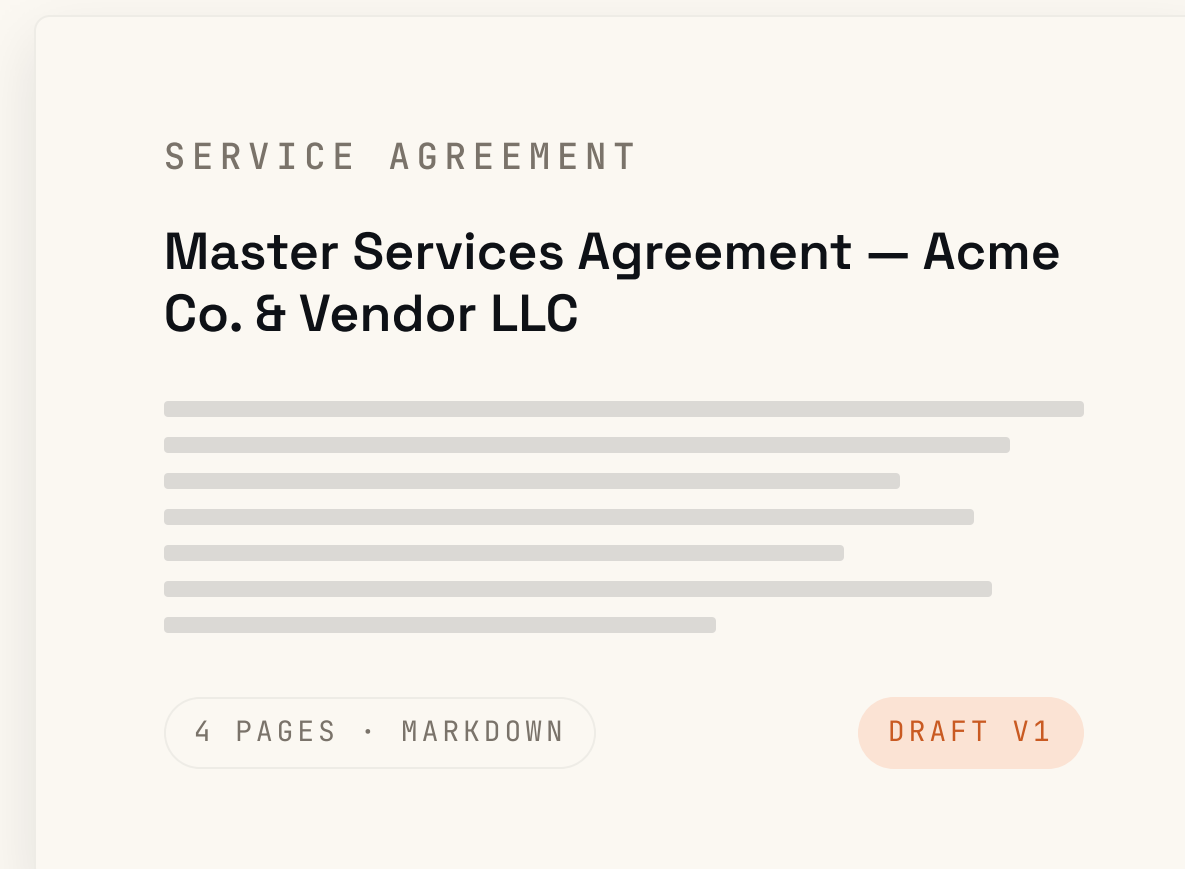
• TODAY'S EXHIBIT

The mock service agreement.

A short, deliberately-imperfect contract — four pages — sitting in `files/mock-service-agreement-4-page.md`. The kind of doc a founder would forward to legal.

— OPEN IT FIRST

Skim the file before you run the review. Notice anything that smells off — vague payment terms, missing IP language, indemnity asymmetry. Then compare with Claude's pass.



Run the review.

Steps

- 01 Confirm LegalZoom is installed: `/plugin list`
- 02 Run `/review-contract files/mock-service-agreement-4-page.md`
- 03 Watch the `attorney-assist` skill load, the MCP probe fire
- 04 Read the verdict. Ask follow-ups in plain English.

CLAUDE CODE • SESSION

```
> /review-contract files/mock-service-agreement-4-page.md
> loading plugin legalzoom ...
> invoking skill attorney-assist ...
> mcp • legalzoom probe ok
```

Reviewing 4-page service agreement.
Found 7 issues across payment, IP & indemnity.

- Section 3.2: payment terms ambiguous
- Section 5: IP ownership not addressed
- Section 8: one-sided indemnification
- ...

```
> ask a follow-up... ■
```

• WHILE CLAUDE WORKS

What good output looks like.

01

Sectioned by risk

Each finding ties back to a numbered clause. No hand-waving — show me where.

02

Rewrites, not just gripes

A good review proposes redline language for the problems it surfaces.

03

Knows its limits

When a question is jurisdictional or strategic, it offers an escalation path to a real attorney.

— DISCUSS

How much would you trust this output before sending the contract back? What's the human-in-the-loop posture you'd want around it?

04

• PART FOUR

The ecosystem.

What's new in the directory as of **10 May 2026**, and what developers are reaching for.

Run the company on plugins.

Five plugins shipped or refreshed in the last week of releases — each one targets a department.

CLAUDE.COM/PLUGINS/SMALL-BUSINESS

Small business

Operating playbook for founders running lean — finance, hiring, ops.

CLAUDE.COM/PLUGINS/SALES

Sales

Pipeline hygiene, call notes, account research and outbound drafting.

CLAUDE.COM/PLUGINS/PRODUCTIVITY

Productivity

Inbox triage, calendar prep, weekly reviews — the assistant table-stakes.

CLAUDE.COM/PLUGINS/PRODUCT-MANAGEMENT

Product management

PRDs, roadmap drafts, release notes, customer-feedback synthesis.

CLAUDE.COM/PLUGINS/MIRO

Miro board

Drives a Miro board — frames, sticky clusters, journey maps — from a single prompt.

• RELEASED

**Week of
10 May 2026**

Five plugins, one week. The directory ships fast.

Learn, model, serve.

Three plugins that help you grow as a builder — from learning to code, to training models, to exposing tools to other agents.

[CLAUDE.COM/PLUGINS/LEARNING-OUTPUT-STYLE](https://claude.com/plugins/learning-output-style)

Learn to write code

Output-style preset that guides your reasoning instead of just handing over answers. Pairs well with side projects.

[CLAUDE.COM/PLUGINS/HUGGINGFACE-SKILLS](https://claude.com/plugins/huggingface-skills)

Build your own AI models

Skills for training, fine-tuning and shipping models on Hugging Face — datasets, transformers, spaces.

[CLAUDE.COM/PLUGINS/MCP-SERVER-DEV](https://claude.com/plugins/mcp-server-dev)

Build MCP servers

Scaffolds a working MCP server — the bridge between Claude and any external system you have credentials for.

Apps, databases, RAG.

Four plugins that cover the build surface of a modern app — UI, persistence and retrieval.

CLAUDE.COM/PLUGINS/EXPO

Build mobile apps

Expo workflows — scaffold a React Native app, run it on a device, ship to TestFlight or Play.

CLAUDE.COM/PLUGINS/PRISMA

Talk to your DB • Prisma

Schema-aware querying — Claude reads your Prisma schema, writes queries and migrations in your dialect.

CLAUDE.COM/PLUGINS/MONGODB

Talk to your DB • MongoDB

For document stores — aggregations, index advice, query tuning. Same posture as Prisma, different shape.

CLAUDE.COM/PLUGINS/GOODMEM

Create RAG

Goodmem — stand up a retrieval-augmented memory layer in front of Claude without writing the plumbing.

• FOR DEVELOPERS • PLATFORMS

Build for the platforms your customers live on.

Shopify and the AWS suite — four plugins that cover commerce, hosting, agents and data.

[CLAUDE.COM/PLUGINS/SHOPIFY-AI-TOOLKIT](https://claude.com/plugins/shopify-ai-toolkit)

Build for Shopify

Theme work, app extensions, storefront APIs — the Shopify-AI toolkit in one plugin.

[CLAUDE.COM/PLUGINS/AWS-AMPLIFY](https://claude.com/plugins/aws-amplify)

Build for AWS Amplify

Auth, data, hosting — Amplify-native scaffolding and code generation.

[CLAUDE.COM/PLUGINS/AWS-DEV-TOOLKIT](https://claude.com/plugins/aws-dev-toolkit)

AWS architecture

Reference architectures, IaC and code samples for the AWS services you actually use.

[CLAUDE.COM/PLUGINS/AWS-AGENTS](https://claude.com/plugins/aws-agents)

AWS Agentcore • Bedrock

Build Bedrock-hosted agents — Agentcore-style — from a Claude conversation.

[CLAUDE.COM/PLUGINS/AWS-DATA-ANALYTICS](https://claude.com/plugins/aws-data-analytics)

AWS data lake / ETL

Glue, Athena, S3 — the analytics path from raw data to queryable lake.

• NOTE

**Most of these need
Claude Code / Desktop.**

Claude.ai sees a curated subset.

Pick one. Install it. Poke at it.

Pick by your seat

- **Founder / operator** → `small-business` or `productivity`
- **PM** → `product-management` + `miro`
- **Eng** → `mcp-server-dev` or your stack (`prisma` · `mongodb` · `expo`)
- **Cloud / data** → an `aws-*` plugin
- **Learner** → `learning-output-style` + `huggingface-skills`

Walk through these

- ✓ Install from `claude.com/plugins/<slug>` .
- ✓ Run `/plugin list` — confirm it's enabled.
- ✓ Try its hero command first. Don't customise yet.
- ✓ Note: what skill loaded? Did any MCP server fire?
- ✓ Ask: what's missing for *your* workflow?

— SHARE BACK

One thing that surprised you, one thing you'd change.

• RECAP • BY THE NUMBERS

What we covered in 45 minutes.

6

CAPABILITIES

2

WAYS TO BUILD • PLUGIN-DEV &
SKILL-CREATOR

14

PLUGINS SURVEYED

4

HANDS-ON EXERCISES

The plugin directory is a moving target. Bookmark `claude.ai/directory` and `claude.com/plugins` — check both weekly.

• WHEN YOU GET BACK TO YOUR DESK

Two questions, every time.

01

Am I installing or building?

Installing — go to the directory, find the slug, enable it.
Three minutes.

Building — start with `skill-creator`. Only graduate to `plugin-dev` when one skill isn't enough.

02

Where will this run?

Claude.ai — agents and connectors mostly. Hosted, easy to share, less authorable.

Claude Code / Desktop — everything. Authorable. Local plus hosted MCP.

• THIS WEEK

Three small commitments.

01

Install one

From the directory · pick the plugin that maps to your *actual* next-week task. Not the most exciting one.

02

Build one Skill

Use `skill-creator` . Encode one task you do every week. Share the `SKILL.md` with the team.

03

Watch the directory

`claude.ai/directory` ·
`claude.com/plugins` . Five new plugins shipped last week alone.

— REPORT BACK NEXT SESSION

Bring one plugin install story and one Skill draft. We'll read the SKILL.md files together and run a quick eval.

SESSION CLOSE

• END OF SESSION

Install
Build
Share
Ship.

Questions?

Bring the install you tried, the skill you sketched, or the plugin you wish existed. We'll work through them together.

THANKS FOR SHOWING UP.



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